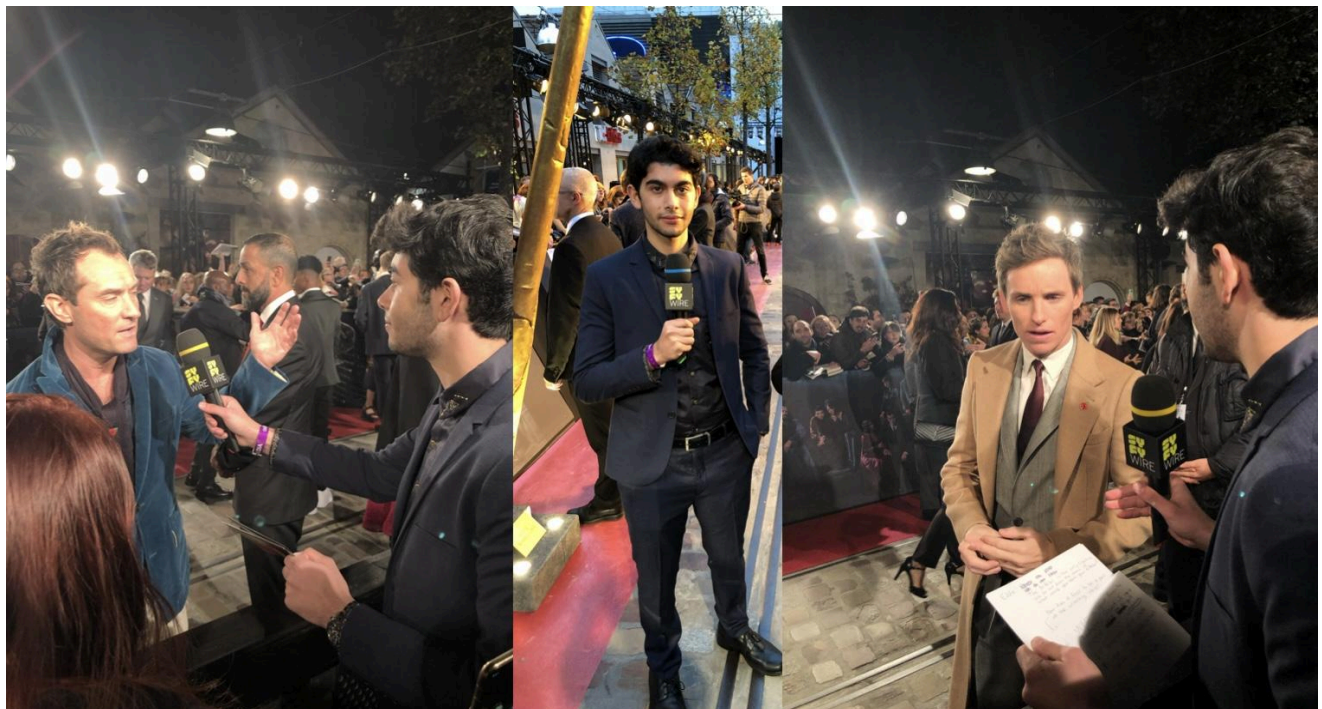
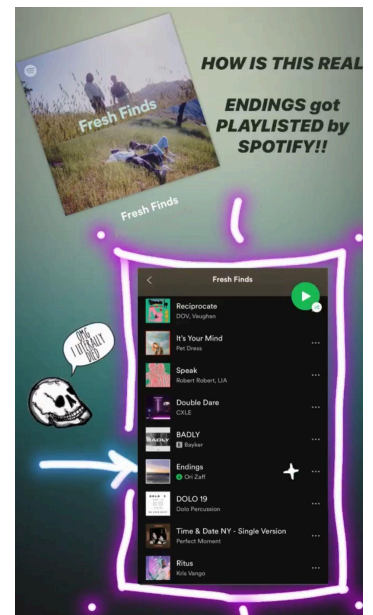


Ori Zaff | Supplemental Work: Content Design & Linguistic Strategy

1. Brand Voice & Expressive Personality

Experience: Content Correspondent (NBCUniversal/SYFY) & Independent Producer (Iconicity) **Goal:** To translate complex brand identities into engaging, human-centric "personally" for global audiences.

- **Broadcast Voice:** Managed real-time brand representation during high-profile red carpet interviews and media launches for **SYFY**, ensuring a "playful and intuitive" tone consistent with the network's character guidelines.
- **Creative Strategy:** Developed the voice and sonic identity for **Iconicity**, resulting in **14,000+ streams** for the single "Endings" and placement on **Spotify's Fresh Finds Editorial Playlist**.
- **Application:** Proves the ability to build "agentic" personalities that feel unmistakable, trustworthy, and aligned with brand standards.



2. Linguistic Logic & Systems Design

Experience: Senior Operations & Research (UPenn / Temple University) **Goal:** Using "Human-in-the-loop" logic to design clearer user journeys in complex systems.

- **The Win:** Built automated Python/VBA workflows that reduced study no-shows by **35%** and improved cross-team efficiency by **65%**.
- **Application:** I treat content as a system. I have the technical rigor to design the "Guardrails" and "Prompt Templates" required to scale LLM-driven features safely.

istart-sharedreward / code / run_L1stats.sh

orizaff L1 and L2 first pass - Ori

Code	Blame	Executable File - 39 lines (32 loc) - 1.15 KB
1		#!/bin/bash
2		
3		# ensure paths are correct irrespective from where user runs the script
4		scriptdir=\$(cd "\$(dirname "\${BASH_SOURCE[0]}")" && pwd)
5		maindir=\$(dirname "\$scriptdir")
6		nruns=2
7		tasks=sharedreward # edit if necessary
8		
9		# create log file to record what we did and when
10		logs=maindir/logs
11		logfile=\$(logs)/runL1_date-\$(date +%FT%H%M%S).log
12		
13		
14		for ppi in 0; do # putting 0 first will indicate "activation"
15		
16		for sub in \$(cat \$scriptdir/debugsubs.txt); do
17		for run in \$(seq \$nruns); do
18		
19		# some exceptions, hopefully temporary
20		if [\$(sub -eq 1240)] [\$(sub -eq 1245)] [\$(sub -eq 1247)] [\$(sub -eq 1003)] [\$(sub -eq 3223)]; then # bad data
21		echo "skipping both runs for sub=\$(sub) for task=\$(task)"
22		continue
23		fi
24		if [\$(sub -eq 1002)] && [\$run -eq 2]; then # bad data
25		echo "skipping run-2 for sub=\$(sub) for task=\$(task)"
26		continue
27		fi
28		
29		# Manages the number of jobs and cores
30		SCRIPTNAME=\$(maindir)/code/L1stats.sh
31		NCORES=15
32		while [\$(ps -ef grep -v grep grep SCRIPTNAME wc -l) -ge \$NCORES]; do
33		sleep 5s
34		done
35		bash \$SCRIPTNAME \$sub \$run \$ppi \$logfile &
36		sleep 1s
37		done
38		done
39		done

<https://tinyurl.com/yc65jbwk>

orizaff updated heudiconv with addintendedfor, predata with singularity for ...

Code	Blame	Executable File - 98 lines (82 loc) - 4.15 KB
1		import os
2		
3		def create_key(template, outtype=('nii.gz'), annotation_classes=None):
4		if template is None or not template:
5		raise ValueError("Template must be a valid format string")
6		return template, outtype, annotation_classes
7		
8		def infodict(seqinfo):
9		tlw = create_key('sub-(subject)/anat/sub-(subject)_T1w')
10		nag = create_key('sub-(subject)/fmap/sub-(subject)_acq-bold_magnitude')
11		phase = create_key('sub-(subject)/fmap/sub-(subject)_acq-bold_phase1f')
12		t2_flair = create_key('sub-(subject)/anat/sub-(subject)_FLAIR')
13		trust = create_key('sub-(subject)/func/sub-(subject)_task-trust_run-(itemd)_bold')
14		trust_sbref = create_key('sub-(subject)/func/sub-(subject)_task-trust_run-(itemd)_sbref')
15		sharedreward = create_key('sub-(subject)/func/sub-(subject)_task-sharedreward_run-(itemd)_bold')
16		sharedreward_sbref = create_key('sub-(subject)/func/sub-(subject)_task-sharedreward_run-(itemd)_sbref')
17		srSocial = create_key('sub-(subject)/func/sub-(subject)_task-socialdoors_run-(itemd)_bold')
18		srSocial_sbref = create_key('sub-(subject)/func/sub-(subject)_task-socialdoors_run-(itemd)_sbref')
19		srDoors = create_key('sub-(subject)/func/sub-(subject)_task-doors_run-(itemd)_bold')
20		srDoors_sbref = create_key('sub-(subject)/func/sub-(subject)_task-doors_run-(itemd)_sbref')
21		UGR = create_key('sub-(subject)/func/sub-(subject)_task-upgr_run-(itemd)_bold')
22		UGR_sbref = create_key('sub-(subject)/func/sub-(subject)_task-upgr_run-(itemd)_sbref')
23		dwi = create_key('sub-(subject)/dwi/sub-(subject)_dwi')
24		dwi_ap = create_key('sub-(subject)/fmap/sub-(subject)_acq-dwi_dir-PA_epi')
25		dwi_ap = create_key('sub-(subject)/fmap/sub-(subject)_acq-dwi_dir-AP_epi')
26		
27		
28		info = {'tlw': [],
29		nag: [],
30		phase: [],
31		dwi: [],
32		dwi_ap: [],
33		t2_flair: [],
34		trust: [],
35		trust_sbref: [],
36		sharedreward: [],
37		sharedreward_sbref: [],
38		srSocial: [],
39		srSocial_sbref: [],
40		srDoors: [],
41		srDoors_sbref: [],
42		UGR: [],
43		UGR_sbref: [],
44		}
45		

<https://tinyurl.com/3cbrhdd2>

rft-mbme-pilot / code / L1stats.sh

Code	Blame	Executable File - 241 lines (214 loc) - 7.83 KB
112		
113		# check for output and skip existing
114		OUTPUT=\$(MAINOUTPUT)/L1_task-\$(TASK)_model-1_type-ppi-\$(ppi)_acq-\$(acq)_sm-\$(sm)_denoising-\$(denoise)
115		if [-e \$OUTPUT] && [\$(cat \$OUTPUT/feat_cluster_mask_stats.nii.gz)]; then
116		exit
117		else
118		echo "missing feat output: \$OUTPUT" >> \$(maindir)/re-runL1.log
119		rm -rf \$OUTPUT/feat
120		fi
121		
122		# network extraction, need to ensure you have run Level 1 activation
123		MASK=\$(MAINOUTPUT)/L1_task-\$(TASK)_model-1_type-act_acq-\$(acq)_sm-\$(sm)_feat/mask
124		if [-e \$MASK.nii.gz]; then
125		echo "cannot run rppi because you're missing MASK"
126		exit
127		fi
128		for net in \$(seq 0 9); do
129		NET=\$(find \$(mask)/mask/feat_rmas_2w_net0000/net).nii.gz
130		TSFILE=\$(MAINOUTPUT)/ts_task-\$(TASK)_net0000/net).nii.gz-\$(ppi)_acq-\$(acq).txt
131		fs1_glm -i \$DATA -d \$NET -o \$TSFILE --demean --dmask
132		eval INPUTS=\$(TSFILE)
133		done
134		
135		# set names for network ppi (we generally only care about EOI and DMN)
136		DMN=INPUTS
137		EOI=INPUTS
138		if ["\$ppi" == "dmn"]; then
139		MAINNET=DMN
140		OTHERNET=EOI
141		else
142		MAINNET=EOI
143		OTHERNET=DMN
144		fi
145		
146		# create template and run analyses
147		ITEMPLATE=\$(maindir)/templates/L1_task-\$(TASK)_model-1_type-ppi-fsf
148		OTEMPLATE=\$(MAINOUTPUT)/L1_task-\$(TASK)_model-1_type-ppi-fsf
149		sed -e "s/OUTPUTS/INPUTS/g" \$ITEMPLATE > \$OTEMPLATE
150		sed -e "s/INPUTS/\$DATA/g" \$OTEMPLATE > \$OTEMPLATE
151		sed -e "s/EOI/\$EOI/g" \$OTEMPLATE > \$OTEMPLATE
152		sed -e "s/DMN/\$DMN/g" \$OTEMPLATE > \$OTEMPLATE
153		sed -e "s/MAINNET/\$MAINNET/g" \$OTEMPLATE > \$OTEMPLATE
154		sed -e "s/OTHERNET/\$OTHERNET/g" \$OTEMPLATE > \$OTEMPLATE
155		sed -e "s/MAINNET/\$MAINNET/g" \$OTEMPLATE > \$OTEMPLATE
156		sed -e "s/OTHERNET/\$OTHERNET/g" \$OTEMPLATE > \$OTEMPLATE
157		sed -e "s/MAINNET/\$MAINNET/g" \$OTEMPLATE > \$OTEMPLATE
158		sed -e "s/OTHERNET/\$OTHERNET/g" \$OTEMPLATE > \$OTEMPLATE

<https://tinyurl.com/mrtwnyeh>

rft-ara-data / code / Outlier0_sharedreward.py

Code	Blame	Executable File - 102 lines (84 loc) - 4.21 KB
49		def _get_sub_value_counts(sub, reset_index=False, reset_index_name=False):
50		df = df_full[df_full['Sub'] == sub].reset_index()
51		
52		for task in df_full.task.unique():
53		print(task)
54		df_task = df_full[df_full['task'] == task].reset_index()
55		mrqc_subs = np.setdiff1d(df_task.Sub.unique(), df_task.Sub.unique())
56		# yields the elements in 'list_2' that are NOT in 'list_1'
57		print("We are missing MRQC OUTPUT (mrqc_subs)")
58		df_task = df_task[df_task.Sub.isin(mrqc_subs)]
59		df_task.reset_index(inplace=True)
60		# find the interquartile range
61		IQR = Q3 - Q1
62		# defining fences as 1.5*IQR further than the 1st and 3rd quartile from the mean
63		lowerQ1 = Q1 - 1.5 * IQR
64		upperQ3 = Q3 + 1.5 * IQR
65		upper, lower = upperQ3, lowerQ1 # so we don't exclude runs with "too good" signal-noise ratio
66		
67		print("These are the upper and lower bounds for our metrics")
68		df_task['lower'] = df_task['lower']
69		df_task['upper'] = df_task['upper']
70		
71		df_task['lower'] = df_task['lower']
72		df_task['upper'] = df_task['upper']
73		
74		df_task['lower'] = df_task['lower']
75		df_task['upper'] = df_task['upper']
76		
77		df_task['lower'] = df_task['lower']
78		df_task['upper'] = df_task['upper']
79		
80		df_task['lower'] = df_task['lower']
81		df_task['upper'] = df_task['upper']
82		
83		df_task['lower'] = df_task['lower']
84		df_task['upper'] = df_task['upper']
85		
86		df_task['lower'] = df_task['lower']
87		df_task['upper'] = df_task['upper']
88		
89		df_task['lower'] = df_task['lower']
90		df_task['upper'] = df_task['upper']
91		
92		df_task['lower'] = df_task['lower']
93		df_task['upper'] = df_task['upper']
94		
95		df_task['lower'] = df_task['lower']
96		df_task['upper'] = df_task['upper']
97		
98		df_task['lower'] = df_task['lower']
99		df_task['upper'] = df_task['upper']
100		
101		df_task['lower'] = df_task['lower']
102		df_task['upper'] = df_task['upper']

<https://tinyurl.com/mtx48xn2>

3. Applied Cognitive Linguistics

Background: M.A. in Linguistics & Cognitive Science (University of Delaware) **Key Research:** *Musical Surrogate Languages* (Collaborative Review) & *Music as Spoken Language* (Independent Analysis).

- **The Foundation:** My research explores the structural intersection of music and spoken language—specifically how the brain processes "intent" and "meaning" across different communicative mediums.
- **The Value:** This academic background allows me to go beyond "writing" and into **Semantic Modeling**. I understand the underlying structures that dictate how LLMs process instructions (Zero/Few-shot) to avoid hallucinations and ensure tonal accuracy.

The 'Meaning' of Music - Pop Press Science Communication 3
LING 890 Independent Study Term Paper
Ori Zaff

Musical Surrogate Languages A Linguistic Survey

Ori Zaff
Thesis

Submitted in partial fulfillment of the requirements for the degree of Master of Arts in
Linguistics and Cognitive Science at the University of Delaware, 2019
Newark, DE

Advisor: Irene Vogel, Ph.D.
Special thanks to Dr. Laura McPherson of Dartmouth College

MUSICAL SURROGATE LANGUAGES: A LINGUISTIC SURVEY 1

Abstract

This paper reviews several musical surrogate languages, or phonemic representations of speech using musical instruments or tone, from a linguistic perspective. Several unique features of each are discussed, as well as underlying similarities. Additionally, possible models for the comprehension of surrogate languages, as well as the potential underlying neurological similarities between language surrogacy and native language production, are explained. The survey covers the languages: Wolof, Asante Twi, Gomeran Spanish, and Seenku.

1. Introduction

1.1 Background: Musical Speech Surrogates

Orthography is a system in which letters and other symbols represent the sounds of human society today. The ability to communicate without proximity is advantageous in the transmission of knowledge, especially at

Key Insights: The Neuroscience of User Expectation

- **On Product Delight:** "Human engagement comes down to a process of expectation fulfillment or subversion. Our brains jump to fill in unknowns with whatever makes the most sense. When we encounter the unexpected—like the 'hippopotamus' effect—it creates a high-resonance 'reward' response that drives deeper engagement."
- **On Emotional Resonance:** "Strong associations create lasting mental markers. When a song is tied to a specific emotional memory, hearing it again triggers a powerful reactive state. **It might not break the highway, but it'll leave a pothole.**"
- **On Intuitive Design (The Highway Theory):** "Reusing existing processing networks is more efficient than forming new ones from scratch. By leveraging the 'highways' of a user's existing mental models, we can introduce complex new features and AI personalities that feel instantly familiar and intuitive."
- **On Semantic Intent:** "Meaning exists when a stimulus brings to mind something other than itself. Whether through music or language, the ability to trigger 'semanticized thoughts' is what defines a truly personalized user experience."